

SAGA TWO BIBLE: THE SECRET WARS SAGA

Phases 4–6 (2021–2031) · Big Bad: DOCTOR DOOM

Status:  LOCKED (the overall structure). The slates and dossiers come when each phase opens.

1. THE FORMAT

Phase	Years	Movies	Disney+ series
Phase 4	2021–2024	9	2
Phase 5	2025–2027	10	2
Phase 6	2028–2031	11	2
Total	2021–2031	30 movies	6 series

Rules (locked):

1. **The movies are the main story.** Every essential beat of the saga happens **on the big screen**.
 2. **Disney+ series are limited to two per phase**, not two per year.
 3. The series **go deeper and wider** (street-level heroes, supporting characters, side stories), but **you never have to watch a series to follow the movies**. Series events can be *referenced* in films, and are always explained there.
 4. Every series gets a **Series Dossier** (same template as the films, plus episode count, runtime and release pattern), written automatically.
 5. All earlier rules still apply: **Earth-616, comic accuracy, nobody gets nerfed, the Casting Rules, real-time continuity and automatic dossiers**.
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2. THE BIG BAD: VICTOR VON DOOM

First appearance: *Fantastic Four* #5 (July 1962), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby.

Played by: **Robert Downey Jr.** (locked in *Fantastic Four*, 2013). In our reality Doom is his signature Marvel role.

Why Doom

1. **He's Marvel's greatest villain.** He's a genius equal to Reed Richards, a **master sorcerer**, **the absolute monarch of Latveria**, and a man who has **stolen the Power Cosmic** and **taken godhood**. No other 616 villain has done as much.
2. **He's already on the board.** We met him in *Fantastic Four* (2013), when he beat all four of them in round one and **escaped by sorcery**. His mid-credit scene set up his **time platform**. In *Avengers Forever* (2019) he **went for the Infinity Gauntlet himself**. Doom has been watching the heroes lose since 2013.
3. **He's the opposite of Thanos.** Thanos was a nihilist who wanted to be loved by Death. **Doom is a man who believes he should rule everything, and he might be right**. He wants to **save the universe**, and to be the one who owns it.
4. **The 616 story is already written.** Jonathan Hickman's run (*Avengers / New Avengers*, 2012–15) leads to *Secret Wars* (2015–16), where **the multiverse dies** and **Doom rebuilds what's left as its God**. It's the definitive modern 616 epic, and it grows out of **the Illuminati**, whom we already set up in *Planet Hulk* (2018).
5. **Nobody is nerfed, and that includes the villain.** At the saga's height, **Doom takes the power of the Beyonders** and becomes **God Emperor Doom**. The heroes have to beat something **even bigger than the Infinity Gauntlet**.

Comic-accurate canon (locked)

- **Origin:** a Romani boy from **Latveria**. His mother **Cynthia** made a pact with **Mephisto** and died for it. **Mephisto already exists in our MCU** (Ciarán Hinds), and **Doom's lifelong goal is to free his mother's soul from Mephisto**.
- **At Empire State University** his forbidden machine exploded after **Reed warned him**. He trained with **Tibetan monks**, put on **the mask while it was still red-hot**, and took **Latveria**.
- **Science and sorcery:** Doom is both. He's **Sorcerer Supreme-class** (on 616 he took the title in 2015), and his technology rivals Reed's.
- **His code:** Doom **keeps his word**, protects **Latveria's people**, and **never lets anyone else kill Reed Richards**.
- **Doom isn't evil in his own eyes.** He's **the only one competent enough to save everything**.

The cosmic threat behind him: the Beyonders and the Incursions

- **Incursions:** two universes' Earths **collide**, and **both universes die** unless one of the two Earths is destroyed first (Hickman's *New Avengers*, 2013).
- **The Beyonders**, beings from beyond the multiverse, are **deliberately destroying it** (*Avengers/New Avengers*, 2015).
- **The Molecule Man** (Owen Reece) is **the bomb they planted in every universe**, and **Doom's key to beating them** (*Secret Wars*, 2015).
- **The Illuminati have to decide which worlds die**, and that drives them apart. **Black Panther** vs. **Namor**. **Cap** vs. **Tony**.

- **In memory of Chadwick Boseman (1976–2020):** under the real-history rule, **T'Challa died in the MCU in 2020, off-screen, of illness. Shuri (Letitia Wright) is Black Panther** (616: *Black Panther* vol. 5, 2009) and takes **Wakanda's seat among the Illuminati**. The role Hickman wrote for T'Challa is hers.

3. THE SAGA NAME: THE SECRET WARS SAGA

Why this name:

- It's taken straight from 616: ***Secret Wars*** (1984–85, Jim Shooter, **the Beyonder, Battleworld, Doom steals the Beyonder's power**) and ***Secret Wars*** (2015–16, Jonathan Hickman, **the multiverse ends, God Emperor Doom**). **Both Secret Wars climax with Doom becoming a god.**
- Like "the Infinity Saga," it's **the name of a story, not a franchise**. The public won't hear it until the right moment.
- It fits the secrecy that runs through the whole plan: **the Illuminati's secret war** to save reality, fought behind the backs of the heroes who trust them.

The three-phase arc (following Hickman's structure)

Phase	Hickman arc	Where the saga is
Phase 4 (2021–24)	"Everything Dies" (<i>Avengers/New Avengers</i> 2012–14)	The first Incursion. The Illuminati re-form in secret. The multiverse is revealed. Doom watches, and prepares.
Phase 5 (2025–27)	"Time Runs Out" (2015)	The Illuminati and the Avengers go to war over which worlds die. Doom hunts the Beyonders. The universes run out.
Phase 6 (2028–31)	"Secret Wars" (2015–16) and <i>Secret Wars</i> (1984)	The multiverse ends. Battleworld. God Emperor Doom. The heroes' final war against a god who did save everything. The ending: Reed rebuilds the multiverse, and Doom's face is healed.

Seeding plan

- **Phase 4:** a **second Earth appears in the sky** over Wakanda (the first Incursion, *New Avengers* #1, 2013). T'Challa calls the Illuminati. **The Black Swan.** Doom's **time platform** comes back. Mephisto and Doom **start their war over his mother's soul.**
- **Phase 5:** "Time Runs Out." The **Cabal** (Namor's Earth-destroyers) splits from the heroes. **Doom meets the Beyonders. The last Incursion begins.**
- **Final shot of Phase 5:** everything goes **white**, then a single title card: **"SECRET WARS."**
- **Phase 6:** Battleworld. God Emperor Doom. The saga's two-part finale.

4. HOW THE INFINITY SAGA CARRIES OVER

Carries over	How it matters
The Illuminati (<i>Planet Hulk</i>)	Hickman's core cast
The heroes who remember five lost years (<i>Avengers Forever</i>)	They know reality can be rewritten , and Doom knows they know
Doom going for the Gauntlet (<i>Avengers Forever</i>)	He tasted godhood , and he wants it back
Mephisto (Ciarán Hinds)	The keeper of Doom's mother's soul
Warlock and the Infinity Watch	The Gems are scattered. Doom knows where they are.
Harry Osborn and the Goblin mask (<i>Spider-Man 2</i>)	Street-level thread, a candidate for Disney+